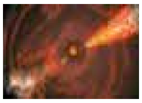
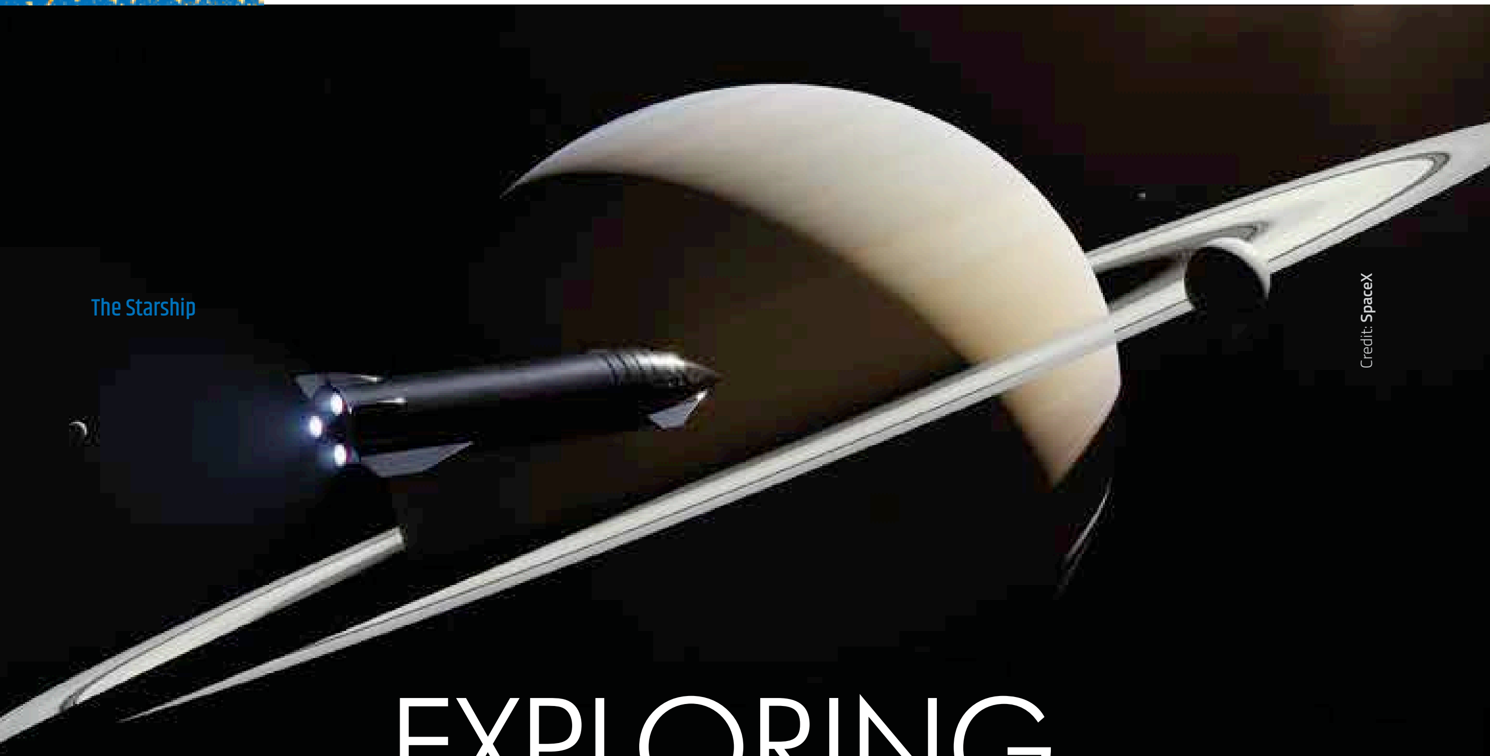
Starship SN4 prototype explodes
SpaceX's Starship prototype exploded after a rocket engine test on May 29. **https://dgit.in/jun20-01**



New type of supernova discovered
Astronomers are calling the newly-discovered supernova explosion Fast Blue Optical Transient. **https://dgit.in/jun20-02**



The Starship

Credit: SpaceX

EXPLORING THE SOLAR SYSTEM

Where would the space tourists go once we can hop between planets?

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In fact, the first tourist mission to the Moon is already commissioned, on a SpaceX Starship. It is an effort to get artists a chance to look at the Moon up close and be inspired. When the Solar System opens up to such excursions, where will humans go? An excelling list of these spots is shown in the Sci-Fi short, Wanderers from Verona Rupes (the highest cliffs in the Solar System, on Miranda, a moon of Uranus) to the 20 kilometer tall ridge running along the equator of Iapetus. The Solar System has many more potential vacationing spots though, and a few of them are here. If you want to check out these locations without a personal spaceship, then there are two options. Switch to 3D view on Google Maps then keep zooming out till you get links to a number of planets and moons in the Solar System, or install Space Engine.

RHEASILVIA CENTRAL PEAK, VESTA

It is just an understandable enough urge to go climb the highest mountain in the Solar System. Sure Olympus Mons on Mars rises 25 km above the surface and is three times as tall as Mount Everest, but it is a shield volcano. The tallest mountain in the Solar System is not on a planet or even a moon, it is on the second largest rock in the asteroid belt, Vesta. The peak is in the middle of a 500 kilometre wide Rheasilvia crater, which is about 95 percent of the diameter of the asteroid! The crater is named after the wolf mother of Romulus and Remus, the legendary founders of Rome. The peak rises 23 km above the lowest point in the crater floor. Anyone standing on the peak would be treated to a delightful sight, as the whole world would literally be revolving around them (technically, rotating). This is because the Rheasilvia central peak is located almost exactly on the south pole of the asteroid. An entire day on Vesta lasts a little more than five hours. The shadows would play spectacularly on the pockmarked surface, because the high points in the terrain, and the rims of the hundreds of craters surrounding the peak would all catch the light from the Sun, while the lowest points would disappear into shadows. It would be a high contrast terrain too, because Vesta is one of the brightest asteroids around. A constant companion to the expedition would be the Milky Way, cleaving the sky in two almost equal parts straight overhead.

GEYSERS ON EUROPA

One of the most interesting destinations in the Solar System would be a trip to the south pole of Europa, when the moon is at its apocenter,